

WOODLAND DREAMS RUFFLE COLLAR

LME BABY COLLECTION - WOODLAND DREAMS

A loose, round collar in stockinette stitch and rib, that fastens at the back with one small wooden button and a crocheted loop. The outer edge is doubled in one simple increase row, giving the collar a soft, ruffled fullness without any complicated stitch pattern. Seven sizes, from 0-1 to 18-24 months, sized to fit the neck opening of the Woodland Dreams basisbody. The ruffle collar is the most romantic accessory in the collection, meant to be knitted in one of the collection's accent colours: sage, dusty rose, butter yellow, soft blue, olive or terracotta, as a nice contrast to the body's calm natural colours.

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TIP: Read through the whole pattern and the size chart on page 4 before you start, and knit a 15 x 15 cm gauge swatch to check your tension, the same gauge as the basisbody, before you cast on the collar itself.

ABOUT THE WOODLAND DREAMS RUFFLE COLLAR

PART OF THE COLLECTION

The ruffle collar is one of six accessory pieces in LME Woodland Dreams, made to be knitted separately from, and worn on top of, the finished basisbody. It is loose and light, sits around the neck and fastens at the back with a single small button, just like the collection's lace collar, but with a fuller, ruffled edge instead of a lace edge.

STYLE

Where the basisbody is kept in calm natural colours, the ruffle collar is meant to add a small splash of colour. Choose one of the collection's accent colours: sage, dusty rose, butter yellow, soft blue, olive or terracotta, and let the collar become the small, romantic detail that lifts an otherwise quiet outfit.

A LOOSE, LIGHT FIT

The collar is knitted flat, back and forth, and worn around the neck as a separate piece, not attached to the body itself. It fastens loosely at the back with a button and loop, so it is easy to put on and take off, and can be worn with several of the body's outfits.

MATERIALS

YARN

Sandnes Garn Alpaka (100% alpaca), or an equivalent yarn with the same gauge, the same yarn as the rest of the collection. Since the ruffle collar is an accessory piece, choose one of the collection's accent colours: sage, dusty rose, butter yellow, soft blue, olive or terracotta, ideally in contrast to the body's calm natural colour.

YARN REQUIREMENTS

Size	Yarn amount
0-1 mnd	15-20 g
1-3 mnd	18-23 g
3-6 mnd	20-25 g
6-9 mnd	22-28 g
9-12 mnd	25-30 g
12-18 mnd	28-34 g
18-24 mnd	30-36 g

The collar is a small accessory piece, one 50 g ball of Sandnes Garn Alpaka is plenty for the collar in any size, with leftovers for the crocheted loop, for example.

NEEDLES AND NOTIONS

Circular needle 4 mm, 40 cm is enough, the collar is knitted flat, back and forth, not in the round. One small, round wooden button. A 3 mm crochet hook for crocheting the button loop at the back. A tapestry needle for weaving in ends and sewing on the button.

GAUGE SWATCH

Always knit a gauge swatch before you start. The same gauge as the basisbody is used in every calculation here: cast on 26 stitches, work stockinette stitch for approx. 12 cm, bind off and block lightly. If your gauge does not match, change to a smaller or larger needle until it does.

SIZE CHART

Finished measurements, measured lying flat. Choose the same size as you knitted the basisbody in.

Size	Neck size (body)	Collar closed, neck edge	Outer edge, ruffle edge	Collar depth
0-1 mnd	21 cm	20.7 cm	36.4 cm	5.0 cm
1-3 mnd	22 cm	21.6 cm	38.2 cm	5.0 cm
3-6 mnd	23 cm	23.4 cm	41.8 cm	5.0 cm
6-9 mnd	24 cm	24.3 cm	43.6 cm	5.0 cm
9-12 mnd	25 cm	25.2 cm	45.5 cm	5.0 cm
12-18 mnd	26 cm	26.1 cm	47.3 cm	5.0 cm
18-24 mnd	27 cm	27.0 cm	49.1 cm	5.0 cm

The neck edge of the collar is knitted very slightly narrower than the actual neck measurement, since the button and loop at the back add a few millimetres once closed, see the back-opening page.

GAUGE AND DIFFICULTY LEVEL

GAUGE

22 stitches and 30 rows in stockinette stitch = 10 x 10 cm, on 4 mm needles, exactly the same gauge as the basisbody. This gauge is used in every calculation in this pattern.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

Easy to medium. You should be comfortable casting on stitches, knitting and purling, working rib, increasing stitches with k1fb (knit into front and back), and crocheting a simple loop. A nice project if you want to practise stitch increases before knitting the rest of the collection.

ABBREVIATIONS

Norwegian knitting terms with the English terms alongside.

Norwegian	English	Meaning
r	K	rett
vr	P	vrang
m	st(s)	maske(r)
rad	row	rad (strikkes fram og tilbake)
tilslag	k1fb	strikk 1 rett i masken, så 1 rett til i samme maske (øker 1 maske)
felle	dec	felle (strikk to masker sammen)
fell av	BO	fell av / bind off
legg opp	CO	legg opp masker
rundpinne	circular needle	rundpinne
maskemarkør	st marker	maskemarkør
luftmaske	ch	luftmaske/kjedemaske (hekling)
kjedeløkke	chain loop	heklet løkke til knapp

TIPS

- Count your stitches right after the doubling row. They should match exactly the number in the table for your size, this is double the number of stitches you had before the doubling row.
- Work the doubling row a little loosely. Tight stitches here make the ruffle less airy.
- Bind off loosely on the last row. A tight bind-off flattens the ruffle edge and takes away much of the fullness.

HOW THE RUFFLE COLLAR IS CONSTRUCTED

The collar is knitted flat, back and forth, in one piece, from the neck edge to the ruffle edge. Four simple parts, in this order:

1. The neck edge

Cast on along the neck edge (minus the back opening), work a short rib for structure.

2. The plain section

Switch to stockinette stitch and knit a few rows straight down, with no increasing.

3. The doubling row (the ruffle)

Increase every single stitch with k1fb in one simple row, the stitch count doubles in an instant.

4. The ruffle edge and bind-off

Knit a few more rows on the doubled stitch count, bind off loosely.

PART 1: CASTING ON AND THE NECK EDGE

Cast on along what will become the neck edge, minus a small opening at the back for the closure. See the table below for the number of stitches for your size. Work back and forth (flat), not in the round, through the whole collar.

Size	Neck size (body)	Cast on	Rib rows
0-1 mnd	21 cm	40	4
1-3 mnd	22 cm	42	4
3-6 mnd	23 cm	46	4
6-9 mnd	24 cm	48	4
9-12 mnd	25 cm	50	4
12-18 mnd	26 cm	52	4
18-24 mnd	27 cm	54	4

Work k1, p1 rib for 4 rows.

The rib row count is the same for every size.

Check: Count your stitches after casting on and the rib. They should match the number in the "Cast on" column for your size, before you move on to part 2.

PART 2: STOCKINETTE AND THE DOUBLING ROW

Switch to stockinette stitch (k on the right side, p on the wrong side) and knit 6 rows straight down, with no increasing or decreasing. This gives a little drape before the ruffle begins.

The doubling row is worked like this: On the next right-side row, work k1fb (knit into the front and back of the stitch) in every single stitch across the row. K1fb means you knit into the stitch as normal without slipping it off the needle, then knit into the same stitch again (this time through the back loop), before letting the old stitch drop off. Each stitch then becomes two. Worked into every stitch across the row, this doubles the stitch count exactly, and it is this doubling itself, not a stitch pattern or a tighter gauge, that gives the collar its soft, ruffled fullness.

Size	Stockinette rows	Stitches before doubling	Stitches after doubling (ruffle)
0-1 mnd	6	40	80
1-3 mnd	6	42	84
3-6 mnd	6	46	92
6-9 mnd	6	48	96
9-12 mnd	6	50	100
12-18 mnd	6	52	104
18-24 mnd	6	54	108

Check: Count your stitches right after the doubling row. They should match exactly the number in the "Stitches after doubling" column for your size, this is exactly double the number of stitches you had before the doubling row.

PART 3: THE RUFFLE EDGE AND BIND-OFF

On the doubled stitch count you knit a few more rows, this is the ruffle edge itself, before binding off. Garter stitch (knit every row) makes the edge lie flat and stops it from curling.

Knit every row (garter stitch) for 4 rows. Bind off all stitches loosely in knit. A tight bind-off flattens the ruffle and takes away much of the fullness.

Size	Garter stitch rows	Stitches at bind-off	Finished depth	Finished outer edge
0-1 mnd	4	80	5.0 cm	36.4 cm
1-3 mnd	4	84	5.0 cm	38.2 cm
3-6 mnd	4	92	5.0 cm	41.8 cm
6-9 mnd	4	96	5.0 cm	43.6 cm
9-12 mnd	4	100	5.0 cm	45.5 cm
12-18 mnd	4	104	5.0 cm	47.3 cm
18-24 mnd	4	108	5.0 cm	49.1 cm

The finished depth is the same for all sizes (5 cm), it is the circumference, not the length, that is graded up through the sizes.

BACK OPENING AND BUTTON CLOSURE

The collar is knitted flat from end to end, so the two short edges of the knitting (the start and end edges) meet at centre back when the collar is worn, and close with a button and loop. The same solution as the collection's lace collar, but here one button is enough.

- 1 Crochet a loop with a 3 mm hook onto one short edge of the collar: attach the yarn at the corner, crochet a chain of approx. 8-10 chain stitches (long enough for the button to slide through), fasten the chain back into the same corner, and fasten off.
- 2 Sew the small wooden button onto the other short edge, directly opposite the loop.
- 3 Try the collar on (or measure against the body's neck) and adjust the loop length if needed, before sewing it on for good.

If you prefer a knitted loop instead: knit a short i-cord on 3-4 stitches, approx. 4-5 cm long, on double-pointed needles or a small 4 mm circular needle, and attach the ends into each corner instead of the crocheted chain.

FINISHING

- 1 Weave in all loose ends securely on the wrong side, and trim them short.
- 2 Sew on the wooden button and crochet the loop, see the previous page.
- 3 Lightly steam-block the collar on the wrong side, avoid pressing directly on the ribbed edge or the ruffle edge, they should keep their stretch and fullness.
- 4 Put the collar around the body's neck and button it closed at the back, check that the button and loop are both securely attached.

SAFETY AND CARE

SAFETY

- Always use a small, securely attached button, and sew it on with double thread, several times through each hole.
- Check the button and the loop regularly, especially after washing, and reattach them at the first sign of looseness.
- This pattern is not intended for children who put small objects in their mouth unsupervised, never leave a baby alone and unsupervised in the collar during the first while of wearing it.
- All measurements and stitch counts in this pattern are calculated for a loose, comfortable fit, not a tight safety fit, always follow current safety recommendations for children's clothing and accessories.

CARE INSTRUCTIONS

Hand wash gently in lukewarm water with wool wash, or machine wash on a wool cycle at 30 degrees. Press out the water, ease the ruffle edge gently into shape, and dry lying flat on a towel. Avoid hanging the collar up to dry, alpaca can stretch out of shape.

ALL DONE!

Congratulations, your ruffle collar is finished! It is made to button around the neck of the Woodland Dreams basisbody, as the most romantic of the accessories in the collection.

THE REST OF THE COLLECTION

- Basisbody, the knitted foundation, with raglan sleeves and buttons at the crotch.
- Lace collar, a loose collar that fastens at the back.
- Ruffle collar, the same fastening, a little more romantic (this booklet).
- Peter Pan collar, a classic rounded collar.
- Bib, tied with an i-cord or a button.
- I-cord suspenders, the collection's signature piece, adjustable and crossing at the back.
- Short vest, with wooden buttons at the front, worn over the body.
- Woodland Fluffy Skirt, a crocheted skirt made to match the body.

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